



## CAN THE YOUNG DRIVE CHANGE?

# “Awaiting the youth revolution”

“We need continuity with change”

**JITIN PRASADA**

MINISTER OF STATE FOR STEEL

In the past 10 years, I have interacted with a lot of people from all spheres of life, be it sports, films or business. And one conclusion I draw is that the youth are at the forefront in all these spheres. In India we have seen that if you want to make a change, it's the politician who has to make the change. That may be true for people in other fields as well but the impression is that you have to become an MP or a minister or an MLA and then only can you drive change and be an instrument of it. That's a wrong notion but we have been seeing a flurry of youth coming into politics as well, and you might say we only see some politicians' sons who actually make it to big positions like me. But on the ground, if you go deeper into the strata, you will see that the youth are coming in at the grassroots level, at the village level, they are coming into their legislative assemblies and that is what is making the difference. When you go out, we see today, the impression that you carry of modern India, you see young boys and girls in campuses, all focused, and then you realise that these youth don't carry burdens anymore. We have seen a whole new India that is coming alive over these past two years. The common complaint, as Rahul Gandhi said, is that the youth are not being represented in terms of percentage in this country today. Political parties in India must make sure that they are catering to the social compositions our country is made up of.

As far as the Congress party is concerned, we believe in continuity with change. There are people who are experienced and at the same time we see the youth coming in and new

people entering the party and trying to make a difference by taking responsibility. That's how we need to move ahead in terms of reinventing ourselves. The other aspect where India stands to gain is where we try in years to come to reap the benefits of demographic dividends that come from such a young population.

But at the same time, when I travel to rural areas in my state, Uttar Pradesh, wherever you go, you see vibrant youth willing to move ahead, wanting to join the growth story of India. They don't need any sort of pity or doles. What they need is equal opportunity. You give them the basics, you give them the education, you give them health, you give them the connectivity and they will be there. That's where the opportunity lies.

I wish to conclude by saying that we have seen in the 19th century, Great Britain was there, 20th, USA was there, and in the 21st it will be India for sure and the youth will be at the forefront of the new century.

“We need to ensure we get the change we need”

**PRASHANT RUIA** MANAGING  
DIRECTOR, ESSAR GROUP

We are the world's fifth-largest economy. We are set to become the second-largest manufacturing economy after China. Seventy per cent of India's GDP is domestically driven. And our success in many sectors, including IT, is well-respected the world over. We are a sovereign country and the largest democracy in the world. But look at it another way: our neighbourhood is consumed with terrorism. We have our share of internal strife and our economy is slowing. We have a growing population of young, educated but unemployed youth that we have to deal with, and our focus

